

Accessing the DOM

Introduction

To manipulate or interact with elements in an HTML document using JavaScript, you must first **access the DOM**. The browser provides two main global objects for this:

- `window`
 - `document`
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The `window` Object

The `window` object represents the browser window. It is the **global scope** in a browser environment. All global variables and functions become properties of the `window` object.

```
console.log(window); // Logs the global window object
console.log(window.innerWidth); // Gets the width of the browser window
```

You don't usually need to reference `window` explicitly, because it's the default context:

```
alert("Hello"); // Same as window.alert("Hello")
```

The document Object

The `document` object is a property of the `window` and serves as the main entry point to the web page's DOM.

```
console.log(document); // Logs the entire HTML document as a DOM tree
console.log(document.URL); // Gets the current page URL
```

Common Properties of document

Property	Description
<code>document.body</code>	Refers to the <code><body></code> element
<code>document.head</code>	Refers to the <code><head></code> element
<code>document.title</code>	Gets or sets the document's title
<code>document.URL</code>	Returns the full URL of the page

Example

```
<!DOCTYPE html>
<html>
  <head>
    <title>Accessing the DOM</title>
  </head>
  <body>
    <h1>Hello World</h1>
    <script>
      console.log(document.title); // "Accessing the DOM"
      document.title = "New Title";
    </script>
  </body>
</html>
```

Summary

- The `window` object is the global context and represents the browser window.
- The `document` object gives you access to the DOM structure of the HTML page.
- You use `document` to navigate and manipulate HTML elements via JavaScript.